

10 Cold Email Templates for AI Freelancers

Ready-to-Send Templates That Book Calls — by @taruns_ai

These are the exact email frameworks I used to land 15 staffing firms, achieve 93-98% email open rates, and build to Top Rated Plus on Upwork with 100% Job Success. Every template is under 80 words. Copy, customize the brackets, and send.

Golden rules: First line is always about THEM. Never pitch in the first email. Keep every email under 80 words. One clear CTA per email. Send between 8-10am in their timezone.

1. FIRST OUTREACH TO A NEW PROSPECT

Subject line:

Quick question about [their company name]'s [specific process]

Hi [First Name],

I noticed [specific observation about their business – e.g., "you're hiring 3 recruiters on LinkedIn right now"].

Most [their industry] teams I work with are still doing [pain point] manually. One staffing firm I helped cut hiring time from 6 weeks to 1 week using a simple automation.

Would a 15-minute walkthrough of how that works be useful?

Best,

[Your name]

When to use: First-ever contact with a cold prospect. Research them for 2 minutes first so the opening line is specific to their situation.

2. FOLLOW-UP — DAY 3 (ADD VALUE)

Subject line:

Re: Quick question about [their company name]'s [specific process]

Hi [First Name],

Following up on my last note. Thought you might find this useful –

I mapped out 3 workflows [their industry] companies automate first:

1. Lead follow-up sequences (biggest ROI)
2. Weekly reporting dashboards
3. Client onboarding checklists

Happy to share the breakdown if any of these hit home.

[Your name]

When to use: 3 days after Template 1 with no reply. You're adding value, not asking again. The list gives them a reason to respond.

3. FOLLOW-UP — DAY 7 (NEW ANGLE)

Subject line:

[Their industry] + AI automation – quick case study

Hi [First Name],

Different angle – a healthcare client I work with cut ad spend by 30% by automating their candidate pipeline instead of buying more leads.

Their qualified candidate rate went from 40% to 78%.

If lead quality (not just volume) is a priority for you, I'd love to share how they did it. 15 minutes – no pitch.

[Your name]

When to use: 7 days after first email. New subject line, new angle, real case study. The "no pitch" line lowers resistance.

4. FOLLOW-UP — DAY 14 (GRACEFUL EXIT)

Subject line:

Closing the loop

Hi [First Name],

I've reached out a few times and don't want to be a pest.

If automating [their pain point] isn't a priority right now, totally understand. I'll close this thread.

But if timing changes – my calendar's always open for a quick 15-minute

audit: [Calendly link]

All the best,
[Your name]

When to use: Final follow-up. The "closing the loop" subject gets high open rates. Many prospects reply at this stage because the pressure is off.

5. POST-DISCOVERY CALL — SENDING THE PROPOSAL

Subject line:

[Their company] automation proposal – as discussed

Hi [First Name],

Great speaking with you today. As promised, here's the proposal covering:

- [Problem 1 they mentioned] – automated with [solution]
- [Problem 2 they mentioned] – automated with [solution]
- Timeline: [X] weeks | Investment: \$[amount]

I've kept it to exactly what we discussed – no fluff. Happy to jump on a quick call if any questions come up.

[Your name]

When to use: Within 2 hours of your discovery call. Speed signals professionalism. Reference their exact words from the call.

6. AFTER "LET ME THINK ABOUT IT"

Subject line:

One thing I forgot to mention

Hi [First Name],

Totally understand wanting to think it over.

One thing I didn't mention – I typically include a 2-week post-launch support window at no extra charge. If anything breaks or needs tweaking, I handle it.

No rush on your end. If it helps, I can also break the project into a smaller Phase 1 to start. Let me know what works.

[Your name]

When to use: 24-48 hours after they say "let me think about it." Reduces risk with the support window and offers a smaller commitment.

7. AFTER PROJECT COMPLETION — ASKING FOR A TESTIMONIAL

Subject line:

Quick favor (30 seconds)

Hi [First Name],

Really enjoyed working on [project name]. Glad we hit [specific result – e.g., "the 1-week hiring turnaround"].

Would you be open to sharing a quick 2-3 sentence testimonial about the experience? Here's a fill-in-the-blank if it helps:

"Before working with [Your name], we [old problem]. After the project, we [new result]. I'd recommend them to [who]."

Totally optional – appreciate you either way.

[Your name]

When to use: 3-5 days after project delivery, once the client has seen results. The fill-in-the-blank format makes it effortless for them.

8. AFTER PROJECT COMPLETION — REFERRAL REQUEST

Subject line:

Know anyone who'd benefit from this?

Hi [First Name],

Loved working with your team on [project]. Since we got [specific result], I figured you might know 1-2 other [their industry] folks dealing with the same [pain point].

If anyone comes to mind, I'd be happy to offer them a free 15-minute automation audit as a starting point.

No pressure at all – just thought I'd ask.

[Your name]

When to use: 1-2 weeks after project completion. Only ask after they've confirmed they're happy with results. The free audit makes it easy for them to refer.

9. RE-ENGAGING A PAST CLIENT (3+ MONTHS LATER)

Subject line:

How's [project/automation name] running?

Hi [First Name],

It's been a few months since we wrapped [project name]. Wanted to check in – how's everything running?

Since then I've built some new workflows that [their industry] teams love:

- [Relevant new automation 1]
- [Relevant new automation 2]

If anything needs tuning or you have a new bottleneck, I'd love to help. Free to chat this week?

[Your name]

When to use: 3-6 months after project end. The check-in is genuine — and plants the seed for new work. Many of my repeat clients came from this exact email.

10. MONTHLY CHECK-IN TO PAST CLIENTS

Subject line:

[Month] automation tip for [their industry]

Hi [First Name],

Quick monthly tip – I've been seeing [their industry] teams get great results with [specific tactic or tool].

One client used it to [specific result with numbers].

If this is relevant to your team, happy to show you the setup. If not, no worries – see you next month.

Best,
[Your name]

When to use: Send on the first Monday of each month to all past clients. Rotate tips between automation ideas, AI tools, and industry trends. This is how you stay top-of-mind without being salesy.

The system that works: Send Template 1 on Day 1. Template 2 on Day 3. Template 3 on Day 7. Template 4 on Day 14. If they reply at any stage, move to a discovery call, then use Template 5. After project delivery, use Templates 7-10 to build a referral engine. This sequence alone helped me achieve 93-98% open rates across 15 staffing firm clients.

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